POS Discount

A quick guide to giving a manual discount at the Phoca Cart POS, as a flat amount or a percentage.

Plugin and guide by David Leeman.

What it does

Authorised staff can take money off a sale at the till. They type a figure, choose **%** or **£** with a button, and press **Apply Discount**. The discount is shared across every item in the basket and appears on the screen, the receipt and the order record, like any other Phoca Cart discount. The shop owner decides who is allowed, and can set limits.

This guide has two parts. **Part A** is for the shop owner or administrator (one-off setup). **Part B** is for staff at the till, and follows one sale from start to finish.

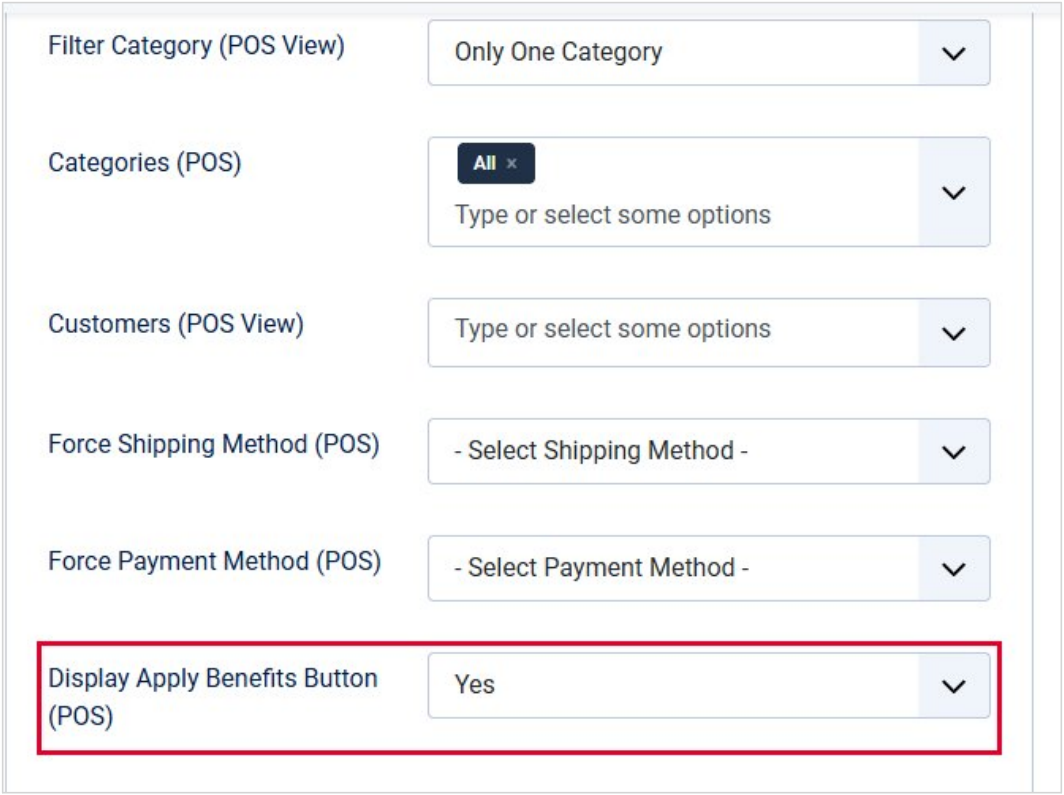
Part A. Setting it up (owner or administrator)

Step 1 Install and enable

In Joomla go to **Extensions, Install** and upload **plg_system_phocacartposdiscount_v1.0.0.zip**. Then go to **Extensions, Plugins**, find **System - Phoca Cart POS Discount** and set it to **Enabled**. Until step 3 is done, nobody can give discounts.

Step 2 Switch on the Apply Benefits button in Phoca Cart

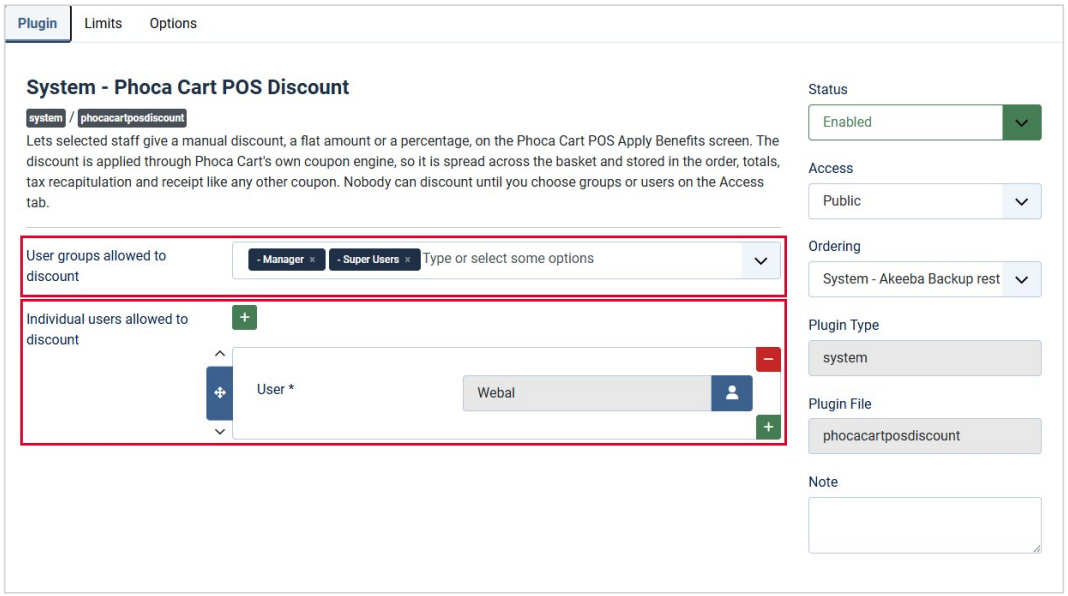
Go to **Components, Phoca Cart**, open **Options**, choose the **POS** tab and set **Display Apply Benefits Button (POS)** to **Yes**, then save. Without this the till has no Apply Benefits screen, so there is nowhere for the discount to appear. Coupons must also be enabled in the Phoca Cart Options (they are by default).



Phoca Cart Options, POS tab: set Display Apply Benefits Button (POS) to Yes.

Step 3 Choose who can discount

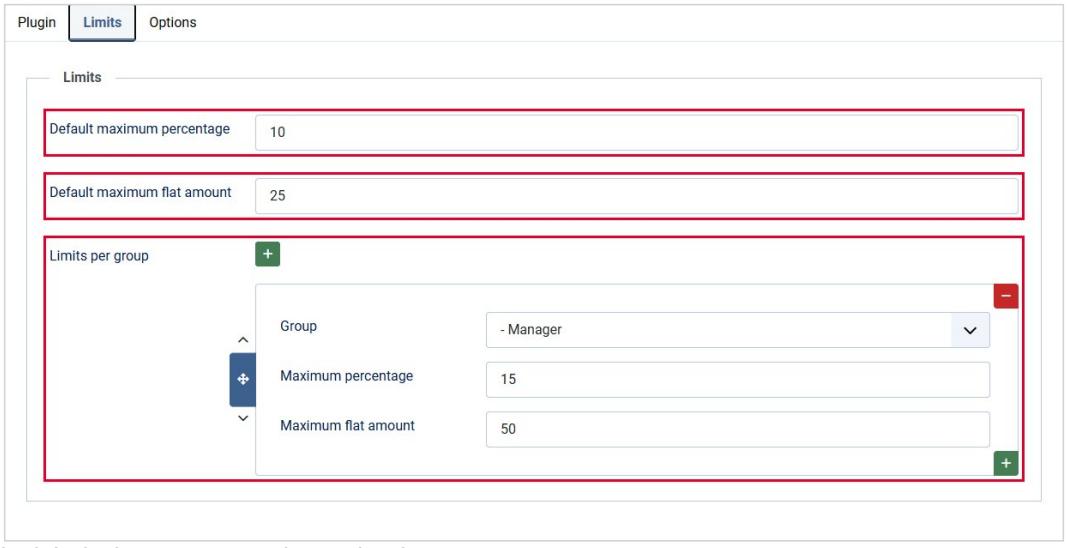
Open the plugin and use the first tab. **User groups allowed to discount** lists the Joomla groups whose members may discount (members of child groups are included, as everywhere in Joomla). **Individual users** lets you add particular people on top of the groups, for example one trusted team member who is not in a manager group.



Plugin settings, first tab: groups and individual users.

Step 4 Set limits (optional)

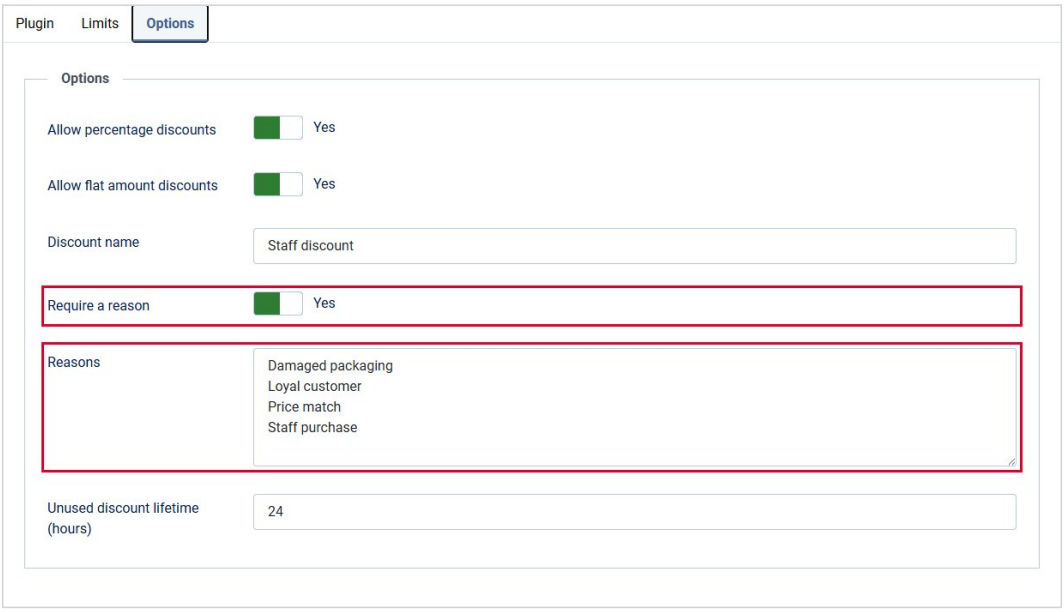
On the **Limits** tab you can cap how much staff may give. A value of **0 means no limit**. **Default maximum percentage** and **Default maximum flat amount** apply to everyone allowed. Under **Limits per group** add a row for a group (for example Managers) to give that group its own higher or lower caps. A person in several listed groups gets the most generous row. Whatever the settings, a discount can never be more than 100% or more than the basket total.



Limits tab: defaults for everyone, and an optional row per group.

Step 5 Choose the options

On the **Options** tab you can allow only percentage or only flat discounts, change the **Discount name** shown on receipts, and make a **reason** compulsory. If you list reasons (one per line) staff choose from a dropdown; if you leave the list empty they type their own. The reason is kept with the discount for your records. Unused discounts expire after the number of hours you set.



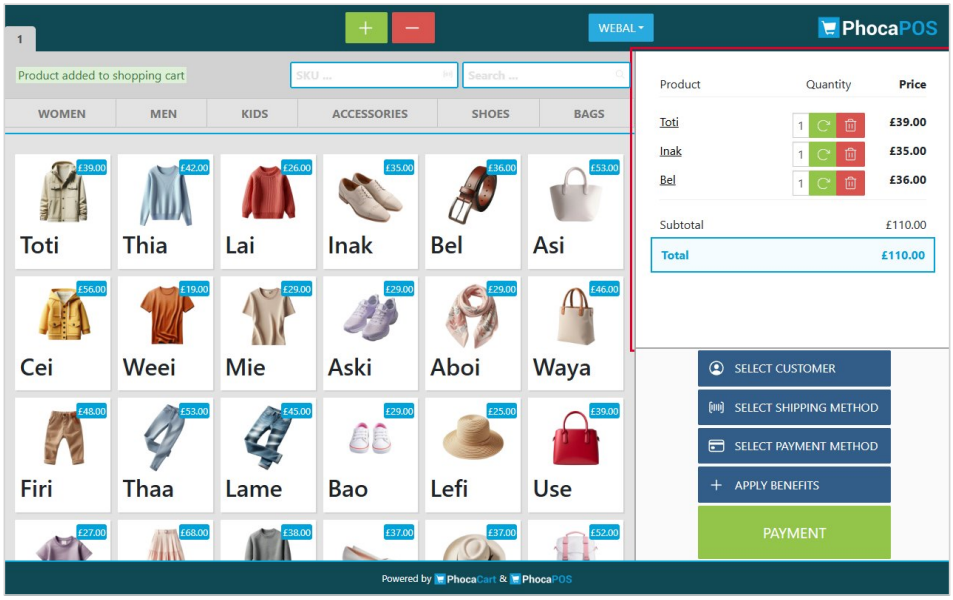
Options tab: reason, reason list and discount name.

Part B. At the till (staff)

Example sale. A regular customer buys a **Toti jacket (£39.00)**, **Inak shoes (£35.00)** and a **Bel belt (£36.00)**. That is £110.00. The owner has agreed **10% off** for loyal customers. (The till shows button names in capitals, for example APPLY DISCOUNT; this guide writes them as Apply Discount.)

Step 1 Add the products

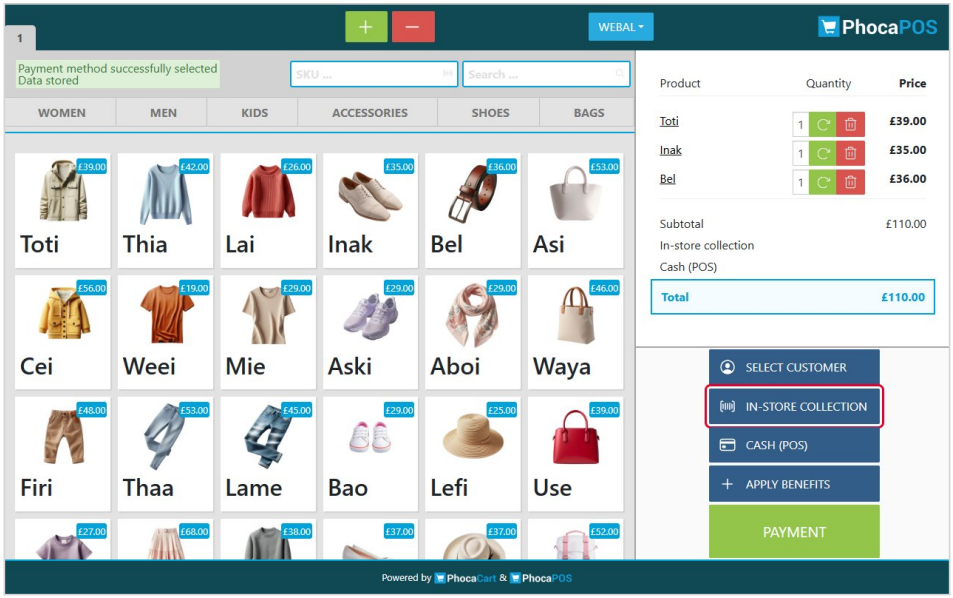
Open the POS with an empty ticket and tap each product once. The basket on the right lists them with their prices and shows the total, here £110.00.



Three products in the basket, total £110.00.

Step 2 Choose shipping and payment

Use **Select shipping method** (In-store collection) and **Select payment method** (Cash). The chosen names then show on the buttons.

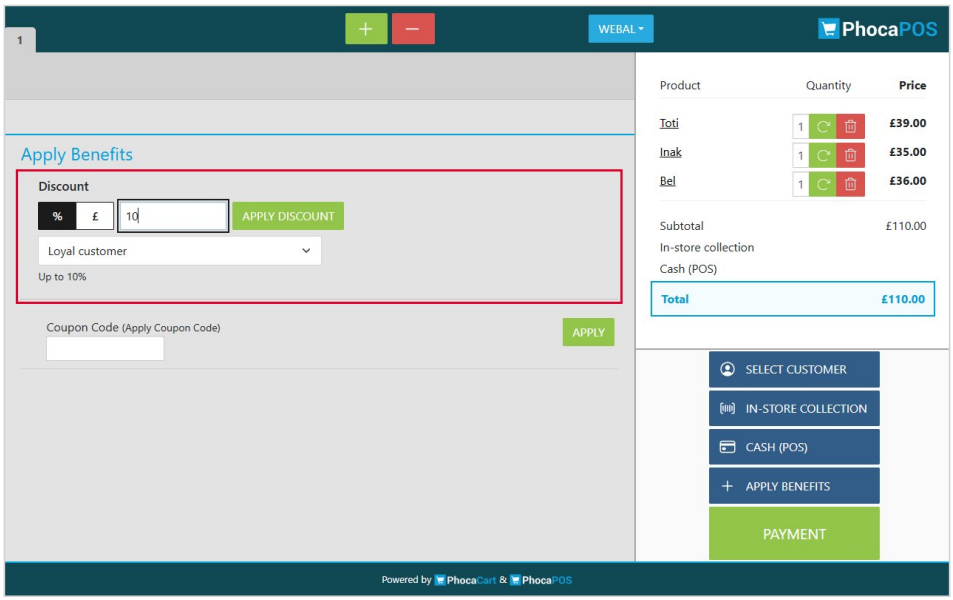


Shipping and payment chosen.

Step 3 Open Apply Benefits and key the discount

Press **Apply Benefits**. If you are allowed to discount, a **Discount** box appears at the top. If you do not see it, you do not have permission (ask the shop owner). The normal Coupon Code box is underneath and works as before.

Press **%** for a percentage or **£** for a flat amount (the dark button is the one selected). Type the figure, here **10**, and choose a reason if asked. The small note under the box shows the most you are allowed to give (here "Up to 10%").

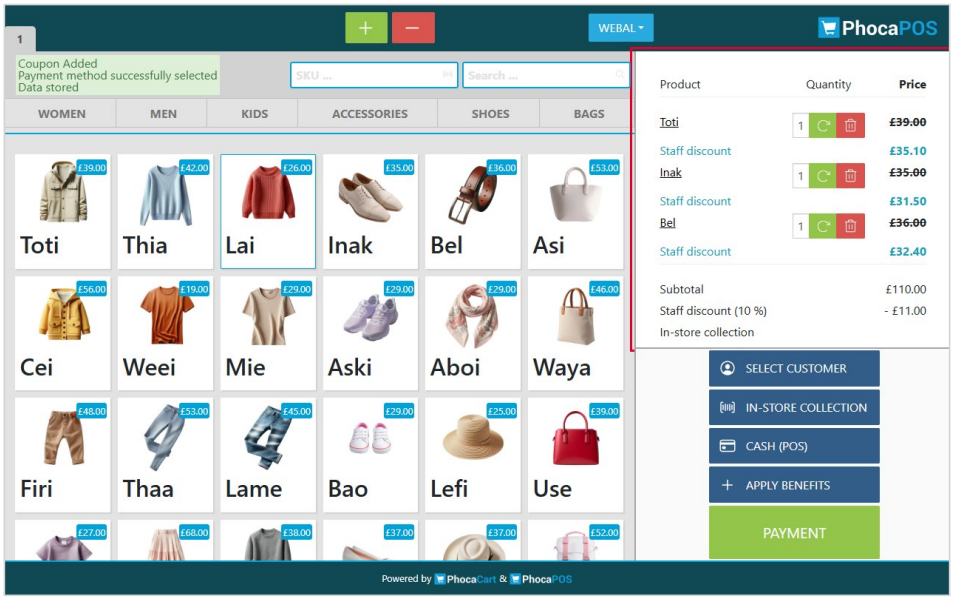


Percentage selected, 10 typed, reason chosen.

Step 4 Press Apply Discount

The basket updates straight away. Each item shows its original price crossed out with the discounted price underneath, the discount line shows the percentage and the amount taken off, and the total drops.

The sum: £110.00 less 10% (£11.00) = **£99.00**. The jacket becomes £35.10, the shoes £31.50 and the belt £32.40.



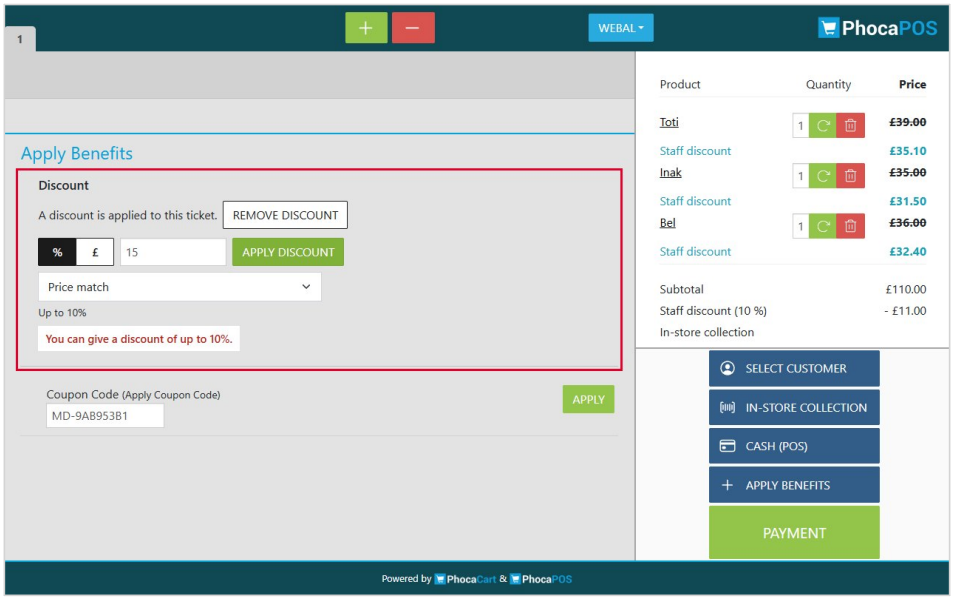
Discount applied: £11.00 off, total £99.00.

Flat amounts and the £ button

To take off a fixed sum instead, press the **£** button and type the amount, for example 5. The amount is shared across the items in proportion to their price. For example £5.00 off a basket of a £39.00 jacket and a £36.00 belt (£75.00) gives £36.40 and £33.60, and a total of £70.00.

Step 5 Limits, changes and removing a discount

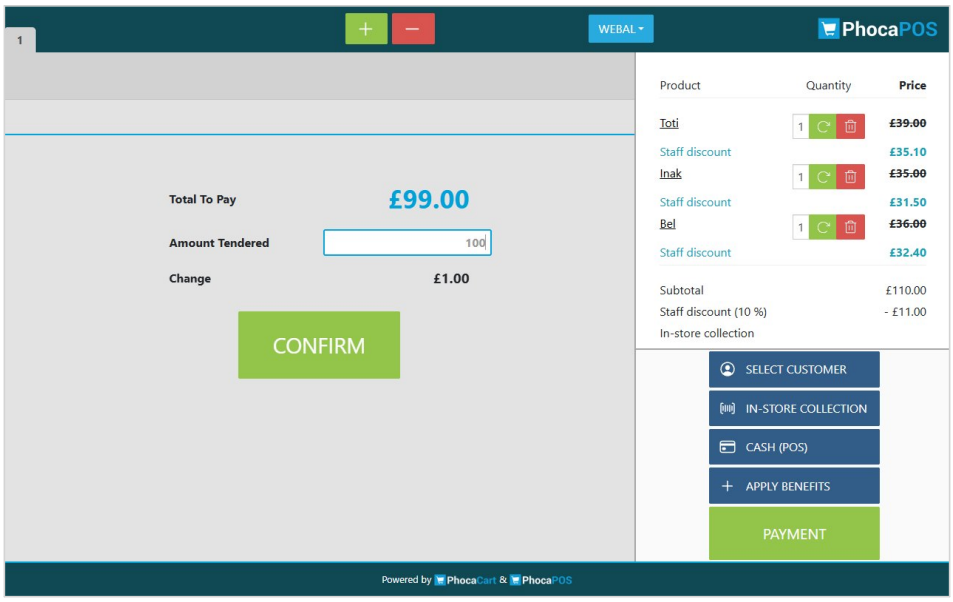
Going over your limit shows a red message and nothing is applied, as here where 15% was tried against a 10% limit. When a discount is on the ticket the box also says so and offers **Remove Discount**. Applying a new figure replaces the old discount.



A discount is already applied (Remove Discount offered); a 15% attempt is refused.

Step 6 Take payment

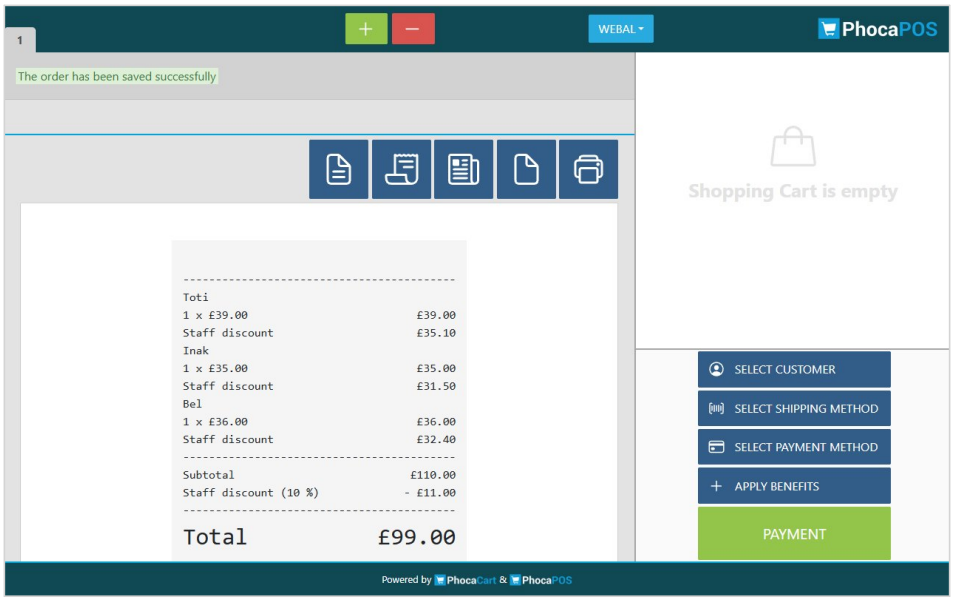
Press **Payment**. The amount to pay is the discounted total. For cash, type the amount the customer hands over and the change is worked out for you, then press **Confirm**.



Payment screen: amount to pay £99.00.

Step 7 The receipt

The sale is saved and the receipt shows each item at its discounted price, the discount line and the total. The same figures are stored in the order, so they appear in order history and reports.



Receipt with the discount line and total £99.00.

Good to know

- **One discount per ticket.** A new discount replaces the previous one. A discount cannot be combined with a coupon code on the same ticket.
- **A discount stays on the ticket** until you press **Remove Discount** or the sale is completed. If a customer walks away mid-sale, remove the discount before serving the next person.
- **POS only.** The discount cannot be used on the website.
- **Records.** Each discount keeps who gave it, the amount or percentage, the reason and the time. Discounts used on an order are never deleted.

If something looks wrong

What you see	Likely cause and fix
No Discount box on Apply Benefits	You are not in an allowed group or listed user (Part A, step 3), or the plugin is not enabled.
No Apply Benefits button at all	Phoca Cart Options, POS tab: set Display Apply Benefits Button (POS) to Yes (Part A, step 2).
"Coupons are switched off"	Enable coupons in the Phoca Cart Options. The discount is applied as a coupon behind the scenes.
"You can give a discount of up to..."	You have reached your limit. Ask a manager, or the owner can raise it on the plugin's Limits tab.
"Add products to the ticket before giving a discount"	The basket is empty. Add products, then apply the discount.
"The discount is more than the ticket total"	A flat amount cannot be larger than the basket total.

Screenshots show the demonstration shop: Phoca Cart 6.1.8, Phoca POS template 6.0.0, Joomla 6, UK pounds sterling. Product names and prices are demo data.